Instant Pot Chicken Tikka Masala

Main dishes | Instant Pot

Before you start

Marinate refrigerated at least 30 minutes, up to 48 hours. Poultry setting: 5 minutes, followed by natural release (about 10 minutes). Reduce sauce before adding cream.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Chicken and yogurt marinade

Bowl B - Onions, garlic, ginger, and curry spices

Bowl C - Tomatoes and tomato sauce

Chicken Tikka

- [ ] 2 lb chicken skinless and boneless, I used both chicken breast and thighs [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups plain yogurt I used Greek [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tbsp garam masala [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tbsp ginger minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 5 cloves garlic minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp salt [Bowl A]

(if using 1 lb paneer, just use 1/2 cup yogurt and add the remaining yogurt to the instant pot)

Curry Sauce

- [ ] 3 tbsp vegetable oil
- [ ] 2 large onion chopped [Bowl B]
- [ ] 5 cloves garlic minced [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tbsp ginger minced [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp turmeric [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp garam masala [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp coriander ground [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp cumin ground [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 tsp Mexican spicy chili powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 14 oz fire roasted tomatoes or regular diced tomatoes [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 cups tomato sauce or passata [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups heavy cream
- [ ] 1 tsp salt or to taste
- [ ] 2 tbsp butter unsalted
- [ ] 2 T sugar
- [ ] 3 tbsp cilantro fresh, chopped for garnish

1. Prepare and cook

1. Coat 2 lb boneless, skinless chicken with 1 1/2 cups plain yogurt, 1 tbsp garam masala, 1 tbsp minced ginger, 5 minced garlic cloves, and 1 tsp salt. Cover and refrigerate at least 30 minutes or up to 48 hours.

2. Turn your Instant Pot to the saute setting. (See your manufacturer's guide for detailed instructions on how to use your instant pot.)

3. Add 3 tbsp vegetable oil, 2 chopped large onions, 5 minced garlic cloves, 1/2 tbsp minced ginger, 1/2 tsp turmeric, 1 tsp each garam masala, ground coriander, and ground cumin, and 2 tsp Mexican spicy chili powder. Sauté 3-5 minutes until the onion softens.

4. Stir in 14 oz fire-roasted or diced tomatoes and 2 cups tomato sauce or passata. Add all the chicken and yogurt marinade; stir.

5. Close the lid (follow the manufacturer's guide for instructions on how to close the instant pot lid). Set the Instant Pot to the Poultry setting and set the timer to 5 minutes.

6. Once the Instant Pot cycle is complete, wait until the natural release cycle is complete, should take about 10 minutes. Follow the manufacturer's guide for quick release, if in a rush. Carefully unlock and remove the lid from the instant pot.

7. After pressure cooker cycle and before adding cream, saute to reduce so it's thicker

8. Stir in 1 1/2 cups heavy cream, 1 tsp salt (or to taste), and 2 tbsp unsalted butter. The separately listed 2 tbsp sugar has no addition step in the source; confirm before cooking.

9. Garnish with 3 tbsp chopped fresh cilantro; serve warm with cooked rice and naan or roti.

Notes

Storage in saved recipe: refrigerate airtight up to 4 days or freeze up to 3 months; thaw completely before reheating on the stove.

The source lists 2 tbsp sugar but does not say when to add it. Confirm before cooking. Paneer option: for 1 lb paneer, use 1/2 cup yogurt in the marinade and add remaining yogurt to the pot.